

If you still experience problems, rip the audio to the uncompressed (WAV) format. It takes less memory, but will result in huge files, so ensure that you have enough hard-disk space. After ripping, use an MP3 encoder such as Lame Encoder to convert these WAV files to MP3.

4.4 Going Digital

Till recently, sound cards would convert the digital signal received from the CPU to analogue signals that could then be fed to the speakers. However, this often results in some loss of quality. With the coming of digital speakers, we can now avoid this loss and feed digital audio right into the speakers. But even this comes with a whole new set of problems.

What's up, Jack?

Digital Speakers don't plug into your standard 3.5 mm audio jacks. Instead, many of them use the S/PDIF (Sony/Philips Digital Interface) interface. Popularly, this consists of an RCA plug (the kind you use in TVs and Music Systems) or an Optical Toslink Connection. So if you come home with the new speakers and find that you can't connect them, you should either return the speakers or invest in a sound card that does support S/PDIF.



Make sure
your sound
card supports
S/PDIF

No CD Audio

If you can't hear music from your audio CDs, it's probably because you haven't enabled digital audio from your CD/DVD drive. To do this, go to the Device Manager: Control Panel > System > Hardware > Device Manager. Right-click on your CD/DVD drive and choose Properties. Under the Properties tab, make sure that "Enable digital CD Audio for this CD-ROM device" is checked.